Practice workbook · Peterson and Peterson (1959): how long STM lasts

Procedure, findings and evaluation of the trigram short-term retention study.

7 question parts: 1 worked-example retry and 6 further practice parts.
Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

Practise one question type at a time. Attempt the part inside the red boundary; the rest of the question and any figures are kept for context. Write your working in the answer space.

The first question is a retry of the website worked example, without its solution. Check your answers online with 'Check my answer', or ask your teacher for the answer booklet.

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Type ID: PSY-MEM-06

1. Question 8 · part a · 2 marks

2020 NOV · Paper 01

Worked-example retry · Attempt part a only.

8 Chelsea was asked to go to the shop on Saturday by her mum to buy 10 items. She tried to remember the list of items by silently repeating them on the way to the shop.

On Sunday Chelsea was asked to go to the shop again by her mum to buy 10 different items. This time she tried to remember the list of items by saying them out loud to herself repeatedly on the way to the shop.

Chelsea remembered more of the items on the list when she went to the shop on Sunday.

(a) Explain why Chelsea remembered more items on Sunday.

You should refer to Peterson and Peterson (1959) in your answer.

(2)

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1. Question 8 · part a · 2 marks

2020 NOV · Paper 01

Worked-example retry · Attempt part a only.

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(b) Explain **two** weaknesses of using Peterson and Peterson (1959) to explain Chelsea's memory of the shopping lists.

(4)

Weakness 1

Weakness 2

(Total for Question 8 = 6 marks)

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1. Question 8 · part a · 2 marks · Working and answer

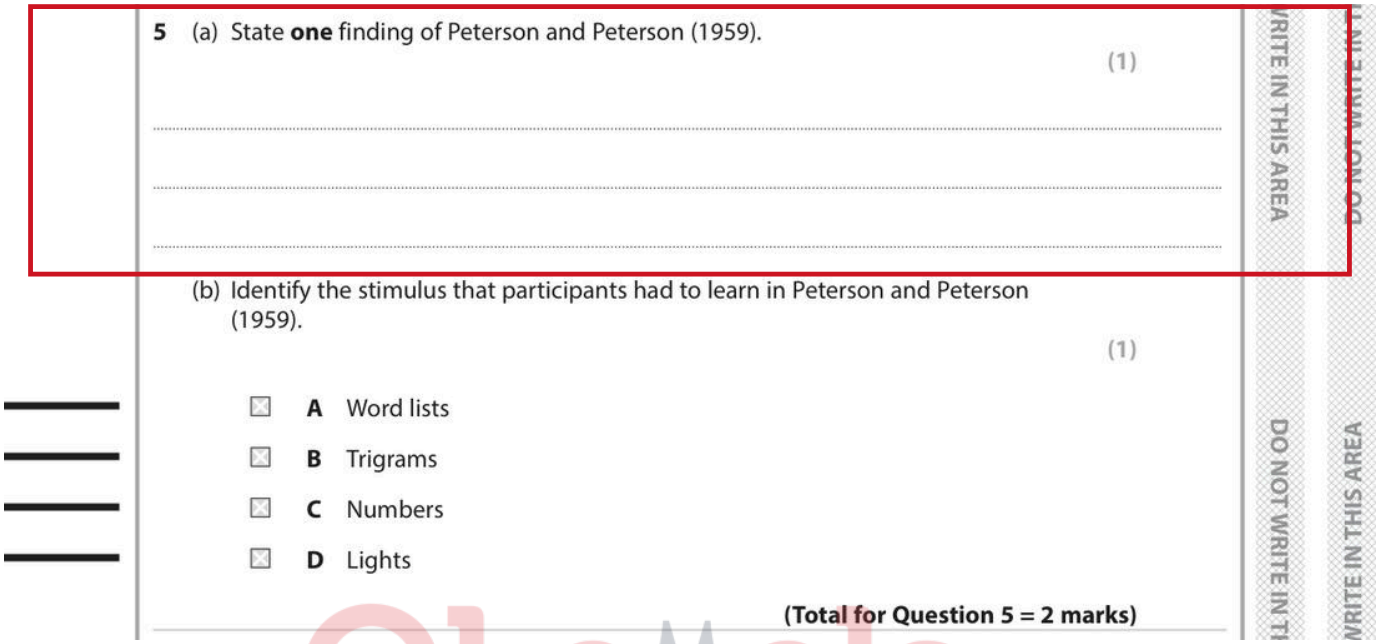
Working and answer

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2. Question 5 · part a · 1 mark

2019 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part a only.



5 (a) State **one** finding of Peterson and Peterson (1959).

(1)

(b) Identify the stimulus that participants had to learn in Peterson and Peterson (1959).

(1)

- ☒ **A** Word lists
- ☒ **B** Trigrams
- ☒ **C** Numbers
- ☒ **D** Lights

(Total for Question 5 = 2 marks)

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Working and answer

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3. Question 5 · part b · 1 mark

2019 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

5 (a) State **one** finding of Peterson and Peterson (1959).

(1)

(b) Identify the stimulus that participants had to learn in Peterson and Peterson (1959).

(1)

- ☒ **A** Word lists
- ☒ **B** Trigrams
- ☒ **C** Numbers
- ☒ **D** Lights

(Total for Question 5 = 2 marks)

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Working and answer

4. Question 8 · part b · 4 marks

2020 NOV · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

8 Chelsea was asked to go to the shop on Saturday by her mum to buy 10 items. She tried to remember the list of items by silently repeating them on the way to the shop.

On Sunday Chelsea was asked to go to the shop again by her mum to buy 10 different items. This time she tried to remember the list of items by saying them out loud to herself repeatedly on the way to the shop.

Chelsea remembered more of the items on the list when she went to the shop on Sunday.

(a) Explain why Chelsea remembered more items on Sunday.

You should refer to Peterson and Peterson (1959) in your answer.

(2)

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4. Question 8 · part b · 4 marks

2020 NOV · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

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(b) Explain **two** weaknesses of using Peterson and Peterson (1959) to explain Chelsea's memory of the shopping lists.

(4)

Weakness 1

Weakness 2

(Total for Question 8 = 6 marks)

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4. Question 8 · part b · 4 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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5. Question 6 · part a · 1 mark

2022 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part a only.

6 (a) Identify the recall intervals in Peterson and Peterson (1959).

(1)

- ☒ **A** 2, 4, 6, 8, 10, 12 seconds
- ☒ **B** 3, 6, 9, 12, 15, 18 seconds
- ☒ **C** 4, 7, 10, 13, 16, 19 seconds
- ☒ **D** 5, 7, 9, 11, 13, 15 seconds

(b) Identify the numbers that participants counted back in before recalling information in Peterson and Peterson (1959).

(1)

- ☒ **A** 1s or 2s
- ☒ **B** 2s or 3s
- ☒ **C** 3s or 4s
- ☒ **D** 4s or 5s

(Total for Question 6 = 2 marks)

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Working and answer

6. Question 6 · part b · 1 mark

2022 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

6 (a) Identify the recall intervals in Peterson and Peterson (1959).

(1)

- ☒ **A** 2, 4, 6, 8, 10, 12 seconds
- ☒ **B** 3, 6, 9, 12, 15, 18 seconds
- ☒ **C** 4, 7, 10, 13, 16, 19 seconds
- ☒ **D** 5, 7, 9, 11, 13, 15 seconds

(b) Identify the numbers that participants counted back in before recalling information in Peterson and Peterson (1959).

(1)

- ☒ **A** 1s or 2s
- ☒ **B** 2s or 3s
- ☒ **C** 3s or 4s
- ☒ **D** 4s or 5s

(Total for Question 6 = 2 marks)

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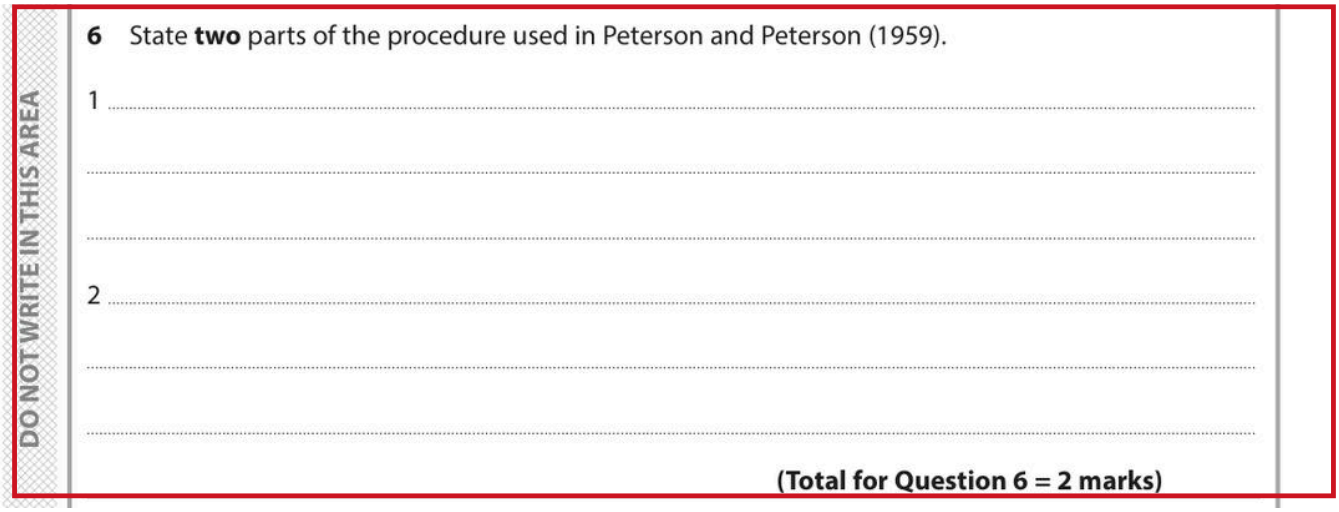
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Working and answer

7. Question 6 · part whole · 2 marks

2025 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.


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6 State **two** parts of the procedure used in Peterson and Peterson (1959).

1 .....

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2 .....

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(Total for Question 6 = 2 marks)

Working and answer

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